

ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL (style)
ACADEX PRACTICE EXAMINATION
O-LEVEL · ENGLISH LANGUAGE

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1122/2

PAPER 2 November 2018

2 hours

PAPER 2 — READING — COMPREHENSION, SUMMARY, REGISTER — 2 HOURS

These are **original ACADEX questions** written to match ZIMSEC syllabus structure, mark allocations and command words. They are **not** leaked or copied official papers. This script is unique to November 2018 1122/2.

Additional materials: The passage is printed in this paper. Dictionaries may NOT be used.

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer all questions. Spend about 1 hour 30 minutes on Section A (comprehension and summary) and 30 minutes on Section B (register).

SECTION A (40 marks) — Comprehension and summary

PASSAGE

A crate of tomatoes

The sun had not yet cleared the roof of the market hall when Rudo set down her crate. Mbare Musika was already a river of voices. Women slapped dust from rapoko bags; a boy pushed a wheelbarrow of cabbages as if it were a stubborn animal. Rudo's mother had fever, and the Form Four fees were due on Friday. That was why a girl who should have been reciting Business Studies notes was tying an apron over her school gym dress.

She arranged tomatoes in a pyramid, the way her aunt had shown her, putting the bruised ones underneath. A man in a faded Caps jersey asked the price, shook his head, and walked on. Rudo swallowed. In class she could argue; here her voice felt thin. An older vendor called Mai Chenai leaned over. "Smile, mwanangu. People buy from a face that does not look frightened." Rudo tried. The next customer bought six tomatoes without bargaining.

By mid-morning the heat sat on the tin roof like a heavy cat. Rudo's feet ached. She kept a small notebook under the crate and, between customers, wrote a sentence of her history essay so that the day would not be wholly lost. A policeman passed, not unkindly, and she hid the book, afraid he would think she was idle. She was not idle. She was splitting herself in two.

Then a woman in a nurse's uniform stopped, counted out money, and said, "These are firm. I'll take two kilograms." As Rudo packed, the woman added, "My daughter is writing this year too. Tell your mother the clinic at Copacabana opens at seven. She should not wait until she cannot stand." Rudo's eyes stung. She had not said a word about her mother.

When the shadows lengthened, she counted her coins twice. It was not the whole fee, but it was a beginning. She stacked the empty crate, untied the apron, and folded it as carefully as a flag. On the kombi home she opened the notebook again. The sentence she had written in the noise of the market was still there, waiting, like a promise she intended to keep.

2. (a) Why was Rudo at the market instead of relying only on school notes?

[2] (b) What advice did Mai Chenai give her, and what was the immediate result?

[3] (c) Explain in your own words what the writer means by "splitting herself in two".

[3] (d) How did the nurse show both kindness and perception?

[4] (e) What does Rudo's treatment of the apron and the notebook at the end suggest about her character?

[4] (f) Give the meaning of the following as used in the passage:

(i) "a river of voices" [2] (ii) "the day would not be wholly lost" [2]

[20]

- 3.** In not more than 160 words, summarise Rudo’s difficulties and the help she receives, using material from the whole passage. Write in continuous prose, not notes. [20] **[20]**

SECTION B (10 marks) — Register · Answer ALL

4. At a funeral, a neighbour is grieving. You should say: **[2]**

- A) Let's discuss the will.
- B) I'm sorry for your loss. I am here with you.
- C) At least they were old.
- D) You'll get over it.

5. A librarian asks you to lower your voice. You say: **[2]**

- A) Other people are louder.
- B) Sorry, I'll be quieter.
- C) This is a free country.
- D) Make me.

6. A visitor asks you for directions to the Head's office. The best reply is: **[2]**

- A) Why do you want the Head?
- B) Ask someone else, I'm busy.
- C) Can't you read the signs?
- D) This way, please. I'll show you.

7. You are late for a lesson. When you enter, you should say: **[2]**

- A) May I come in, Sir/Madam? I am sorry I am late.
- B) It's not my fault, the bell is wrong.
- C) The other class is also late.
- D) What did I miss?

8. A shop assistant short-changes you. The appropriate register is: **[2]**

- A) Excuse me, I think the change is not correct. Could we check, please?
- B) You thieves!
- C) Give me my money before I call the police, now!
- D) Whatever, keep it, poor people.

END OF QUESTION PAPER

Worked solutions and mark-scheme notes are inside the ACADEX app (Extract & Study).